

Lumina Flow: The Financial OS for the Canadian Gig Economy

Automating Financial Clarity for Independent Workers

Presented by: Trung Kien Vo



Introduction & The Gig Economy Shift

The Shifting Canadian Labor Market

Canada's job market is rapidly moving from traditional '9-to-5' employment to a **flexible, autonomous gig economy**.

Founders' Narrative: Our 'Why'

We built Lumina Flow because we've personally navigated the pain of GST filings, multi-currency confusion, and solo business management.



Gig Economy: Explosion & Market Size

A growing cohort of independent workers reshapes the labor landscape.

- 2.4M People (2023 Official)
- 22-24% of Adults (2024 Est.)

This rapid expansion, driven by economic necessity and a cultural shift, is a **permanent feature**.



Lumina Flow's Elevator Pitch

Lumina Flow is an AI-powered financial OS for Canadian freelancers, automating bookkeeping, taxes, and multi-currency transactions.

Transforming financial anxiety into **strategic clarity**—your digital CFO for the future of work.

The Problem: Financial Chaos for Gig Workers



Canadian Tax Complexity

73% of gig workers find **tax compliance challenging**. The \$30k GST/HST threshold is a 'trap' leading to **retroactive liabilities**.



Multi-Currency Nightmare

Cross-border work creates a disconnect: **USD income, CAD expenses**. Generic software fails to unify net profit without **manual effort**.



Wellness Deficit

82% of gig workers experience **burnout**. Current tools ignore **financial wellness and work-life balance** metrics.



Inadequate Current Solutions

QuickBooks is **expensive and over-engineered**; Wave lacks Canadian support and **true multi-currency** functionality.



The Compliance Gap

Many delay compliance due to complexity, risking audits and retroactive tax liabilities when crossing the **\$30k GST/HST threshold**.

"The current financial infrastructure for Canadian gig workers is perilously outdated, leading to anxiety, non-compliance, and lost opportunities."

Lumina Flow: Our Unique Solution



AI-Powered Financial Operating System

Lumina Flow leverages AI for automated bookkeeping, intelligent expense categorization via OCR, and real-time insights, transforming financial management for Canadian freelancers.



Geocentric Compliance (Canadian-Native)

Built on CRA logic, Lumina Flow natively handles GST/HST thresholds, specific write-off rules, and provincial tax variations, ensuring seamless compliance.



Radical Simplicity & Streamlined Features

We strip away corporate features, focusing only on what Canadian freelancers need: intuitive invoicing, expense tracking, and precise tax estimates.



Holistic Business Health: Beyond Transactions

Integrating financial data with work patterns, Lumina Flow provides 'Wellness Metrics' to help users optimize both their bank balance and work-life balance.



Automated Multi-Currency Reconciliation

Effortlessly handles cross-border income and expenses, automatically calculating realized currency gains/losses and simplifying complex USD-to-CAD transactions.

Our Solution: Lumina Flow's Unique Value Proposition

Lumina Flow is an AI-powered financial operating system purpose-built for the Canadian independent workforce, transforming financial anxiety into strategic clarity.

Geocentric Compliance

- Built for Canadian taxes & CRA logic
- Proactive GST/HST monitoring (\$30k threshold)
- Automatic provincial tax rate application

Radical Simplicity

- Tailored features for freelancers (no bloat)
- AI-powered expense categorization ('Swipe-to-Sort')
- Affordable pricing (\$10-20/month)

Holistic Business Health

- Integrates financial data with work patterns
- Provides 'Wellness Metrics' & burnout analysis
- Calculates net disposable income & 'Tax Safe' amounts

Why Lumina Flow Stands Out

Feature / Need	Incumbent (QB/Wave)	Lumina Flow
Multi-Currency	Expensive/Poor	Core (Automated)
GST/HST Alerts	Passive Tracking	Proactive "Nudge"
Wellness Metrics	None	Burnout/Rate Analysis

Product Deep Dive: Key Features

The "Pulse" Dashboard



Tracks **Net Disposable Income** (bank balance minus tax liability) and includes a "Wellness Widget" for work-life balance.



Multi-Currency Invoicer

Allows **USD line items** and calculates "Realized Gain/Loss" on currency exchange, highlighting conversion fees.



"Snap & Sort" Expense Capture

AI-powered OCR identifies vendors and context from receipt photos, suggesting optimal deductions.



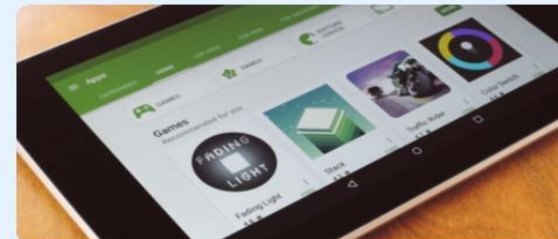
The "Tax Jar" & GST Sentinel

Proactive alerts for the **\$30k GST threshold**. Automatically adds correct GST/HST rates to invoices based on client province.



Mobile-First and PWA Strategy

Progressive Web App (PWA) for **cross-platform access** from a single codebase, with future native app development.



Market & Competitive Advantage

Target Audience: Canadian Solopreneurs & Freelancers



Why We Win: Deep Canadian Specificity

Strengths



- **Hyper-Localization:** Deep compliance support for Canadian specifics.
- **Agility:** Rapid feature iteration based on user feedback.
- **Cost Structure:** Lean "Online First" model enables competitive pricing.
- **Technical Stack:** Modern APIs (e.g., Flinks) for enterprise-grade connectivity.

Opportunities



- **Regulatory Tailwinds:** Increasing government scrutiny on gig economy reporting.
- **Incumbent Dissatisfaction:** User frustration with competitors' shifts to paid models.
- **Fintech Grants:** Non-dilutive funding opportunities for early development.

Weaknesses



- **Brand Recognition:** Overcoming trust barrier against established names.
- **Resource Constraints:** Limited marketing budget compared to competitors.
- **Dependency on APIs:** Reliance on third-party aggregators (Flinks/Plaid).

Threats



- **Incumbent Retaliation:** Competitors launching niche-specific versions.
- **Open Banking Delays:** Potential instability with screen-scraping methods.
- **Economic Downturn:** Freelancers cutting software subscriptions.

Competitive Landscape & Differentiators

Key Competitor Analysis

FEATURE/NEED	QUICKBOOKS	WAVE	EXCEL	LUMINA FLOW
Target Audience	SMBs w/employees	Micro-businesses	DIY Solopreneurs	Canadian Solopreneurs
Cost	High (\$30-80/mo)	Free/Freemium	Free	Affordable (\$10-20/mo)
Multi-Currency	Expensive Add-on	Poor/Segregated	Manual/Error-prone	Core Feature (Automated)
GST/HST Alerts	Passive Tracking	Passive Tracking	None	Proactive 'Nudge' System
Bank Feeds	Good	Paid/Gated Support	None	Aggregator Integrated
Wellness Metrics	None	None	None	Burnout/Rate Analysis

Lumina Flow's Key Advantages

- 🌟 AI-Powered Canadian Financial OS
- 📱 Unified Mobile Dashboard

Three Pillars of UVP:

- Geocentric Compliance:** CRA Logic, GST/HST
- Radical Simplicity:** No Bloat, Focused Features
- Holistic Business Health:** Wellness Metrics, Tax Safe

"We are not just an accounting app; we are a digital CFO for the future of work."

Our Strategy: Lean Startup & Phased Rollout

Lean Startup Methodology

Prioritizing speed to market and customer validation over perfection, focusing on rapid iteration through a 'build, measure, learn' cycle.

Agile Development

Legal Structure: Why Incorporate?



- Protects personal assets (limited liability)
- Secures Intellectual Property (IP)
- Enables eligibility for grants and investment
- Facilitates stock options for team
- Qualifies for small business tax rate (~11% in BC)

Phased Rollout Approach

Months 0-4

Phase 1: Validation & MVP

Legal: Incorporate; Product: Build 'Wizard of Oz' MVP with manual backend; User Base: Recruit 50 beta testers.

Months 5-8

Phase 2: Online First Launch

Product: Launch Progressive Web App (PWA) for all platforms; Timing: Target Tax Season (Feb-Apr) for high-intent traffic.

Months 9-12

Phase 3: Scale & Native Mobile

Product: Develop native iOS/Android apps based on PWA data; Business: Introduce paid tiers & expanded API integrations.

Business Model & Financial Projections

Lumina Flow adopts a **freemium model**, offering essential features for free to drive adoption and clearly defined upsells for advanced automation.

Product Tiers

Tier	Pricing	Key Features
Free	Free	Unlimited Manual Invoicing, Expense Tracking, GST Threshold Monitor
Pro	\$12/month	Bank Feed Automation, Receipt OCR (AI), Multi-currency Auto-Reconciliation
Business	\$25/month	Accountant Access, Advanced Tax Reports, Priority Support

Revenue Streams

- Subscriptions

Funding Strategy

Lumina Flow utilizes a **hybrid funding approach** to ensure sustainable growth and minimize dilution.

- Bootstrapping & Grants (Year 1)
- Pre-Seed Angel Round (Year 2)

Estimated Year 1 Costs (MVP)

Estimated total MVP phase costs: ~\$9,200 CAD, excluding founder salaries.

Category	Cost (CAD)
Legal	\$1,500
Hosting (Year 1)	\$1,200
Banking API (Flinks)	\$3,000
Domains & Software	\$1,000

Team & Legal Structure

Founding Team & Equity

A lean, two-person team combining vision & execution:

- Founder 1 (CEO/Product)
- Founder 2 (CTO/Technical)

Complementary skills in business strategy, UI/UX, fundraising, tech stack, API, and security.

50/50 Equity Split

Vesting Schedule: **4-Year Vesting with 1-Year Cliff** to ensure long-term commitment.

Legal Structure & Systems

Incorporation: **British Columbia Corporation (CCPC)**

- Limits personal liability
- Enables equity & investment

Tax Advantage: Small business rate (~11% on first \$500k).

Key Operational Systems:

- Accounting: Xero
- CRM: HubSpot (Free Tier)
- Project Mgmt: Linear/Trello
- Banking API: Flinks

Marketing & Sales Strategy: Community-First Growth

Lumina Flow's strategy emphasizes deep engagement, data-driven outreach, and transparent community building.



Networking & Events

- Participate in local tech events & meetups
- Offer "Free Tax Health Checkups"
- Partner with co-working spaces



Digital Marketing & SEO

- Produce Canada-specific content (blog, YouTube)
- Target "long tail" keywords
- Leverage AI for content & optimization



Social Proof & Transparency

- Share "Building in Public" updates (LinkedIn, X)
- Document Lumina Flow's development journey
- Foster empathy & trust within community



Website & Lead Magnet

- Develop high-conversion landing page
- Clear Value Prop & "Join Beta" CTA
- Offer "Tax Checklist" as free lead magnet

Financial Plan: Traction, Investment & Revenue

Market Validation & Traction

- Waitlist: **500 signups** (3 months target)
- Beta Testers: **50 active users** providing feedback
- Social Listening: Validates pain points on platforms like Reddit

Hybrid Funding Model

- Bootstrapping: **\$10k** Founders' initial contribution
- Non-Dilutive Grants: Targeting **Innovate BC (\$50k)**
- Potential: **NRC IRAP** for AI R&D funding

Pre-Seed Angel Round

- Target: **\$250,000** (at \$5k MRR, Year 2)
- Use of Funds: **1-2 Devs**, Marketing, API costs
- Target Investors: **VANTEC, Panache Ventures**

Freemium Revenue Model

- **Free Tier**: Invoicing, Expense Tracking, GST Monitor
- **Pro Tier (\$12/mo)**: Automation, OCR, Multi-currency
- **Business Tier (\$25/mo)**: Accountant Access, Adv. Reports

Voice of the Customer: Addressing Real Pain Points



Key Frustrations & Unmet Needs

Freelancers face significant challenges with **multi-currency transactions** and complex Canadian **tax compliance** (GST/HST).

Generic tools often lack **Canadian-specific nuances**, are over-engineered, or provide unreliable support.

"I am frustrated... they don't provide true multi-currency support."

— Reddit User

"I just moved from QuickBooks... Support takes hours or ghosts us."

— Small Business Owner



The Gap Lumina Flow Fills

- **Geocentric Compliance:** Natively handles Canadian GST/HST thresholds & provincial taxes.
- **Automated Multi-Currency:** Unified 'Real' Income view with FX fee transparency.
- **Radical Simplicity:** Streamlined features essential for gig workers, no bloat.
- **Reliable & Localized Support:** Dedicated assistance for Canadian freelancers.

Your Digital CFO for the Future of Work

Conclusion: The Future of Work, Simplified



Strategic Response to an Underserved Market

Lumina Flow addresses the specific needs of Canadian independent workers, a growing market underserved by generic financial tools.



Sustainable Growth through Lean Operations & Ecosystem Leverage

Achieving sustainable high-growth through a lean startup methodology, community engagement, and leveraging the vibrant tech ecosystem.



Making Life Better for Canadian Independent Workers

Transforming financial anxiety into strategic clarity and improving the work-life balance for millions of Canadian freelancers.

Contact: founders@luminaflow.ca